Oct 8, 2025

Meeting Oct 8, 2025 at 15:42 CEST

Meeting records Recording

Summary

Clément Lacaille provided a recap for Vladimir Popovic on API and HTTP concepts, explaining how an API serves as an intermediary and HTTP as the communication language, often using JSON. Clément Lacaille outlined the goal for participants to create a workflow generating videos from prompts using Excel, OpenAI, and a video model like V3, with homework assigned to improve script output through prompt experimentation. Clément Lacaille also demonstrated a custom GPT for character design, highlighting the importance of customized instructions for brand-specific content.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Meeting Recap and Core Concepts** Clément Lacaille provided a recap for Vladimir Popovic, who missed the beginning of the class, focusing on API and HTTP. Clément explained that an API acts as a waiter between a user's request and the service (like OpenAI), while HTTP is the language used to send requests, formatted as JSON. Clément further clarified that JSON is the language format, and HTTP is the request format itself.
- **Portfolio Project Goal** Clément outlined the main goal for the next three days: to create a workflow that generates videos from a prompt, using an Excel sheet for input, OpenAI for scriptwriting, and a video model like V3 for video generation. The objective is to achieve video creation from a simple prompt, and they

emphasized a step-by-step building process with pauses for participants to follow along.

- **Zapier Automation Setup** Clément described the process of building automation in Zapier, starting with the problem of manually generating scripts and videos. They plan to use ChatGPT's help to define the step-by-step workflow for video content creation on Zapier, using a specific prompt structure for the AI.
- **Defining the Automation Context** Clément detailed the context for the AI workflow, explaining that the user will provide an idea for a video, including specifications for actors, content, messaging, and video format, all within about 50 words. The AI's task is to write a script and create the video. Clément also added a requirement to upload a product image to inform the AI about the video's content.
- **Using AI for Workflow Generation** Clément used Perplexity's "deep research" function to generate the step-by-step workflow, noting that ChatGPT or Perplexity should yield similar results. Kai Feldhoff asked if the Google Sheets document being used was accessible, and Martin Hampel and Vladimir confirmed it was in the chatbox, though not editable.
- **Required Tools for Automation** Clément outlined the necessary tools for building the automation, comparing it to gathering ingredients for cooking. These include Zapier for building automation, ChatGPT for scriptwriting, a video generation tool (specifically V3), a drive account for storing files and images, and a Google Forms or Google Sheets account for inputting video requests. They opted to use Google Sheets for simplicity in the activity.
- **Setting Up the Input System in Google Sheets** Clément detailed setting up the input system in Google Sheets, which serves as the trigger for the automation. The sheet needs columns for video idea, product image, and video title, with the option to add more specifications for better output quality.
- **Creating a Zap in Zapier** Clément explained the next step: going to Zapier to create a "zap," which is a no-code automation. This involves setting up a trigger and an action box, with the Google Sheet acting as the trigger for new video requests. Clément emphasized that users might need to research which video model or input method (form vs. sheet) suits their needs, but ChatGPT can provide exact instructions once those decisions are made.

- **Addressing AI Output and User Questions** Vladimir noted that ChatGPT provided a lengthy output, to which Clément suggested asking the AI to summarize or provide step-by-step instructions. Naim Burrack asked about alternative video models, and Sven Lück inquired about V3's cost, with Clément confirming that API keys would be provided, eliminating direct costs for participants. Vladimir also asked about consistency for longer videos and characters, which Clément said would be covered over the three-day activity.
- **Preparing Product Image for AI Use** Clément demonstrated the process of preparing a product image, using a Colgate toothbrush as an example. They explained the challenge of passing files directly from Google Drive to AI tools due to encryption, recommending Cloudinary as a free alternative for storing and accessing images publicly. Clément provided detailed steps for participants to upload their product image to Cloudinary and paste the URL into the Google Sheet.
- **Populating the Google Sheet Input** Clément demonstrated how to input details into the Google Sheet for a video request, including the video idea, actors, target audience, and video specifications. They highlighted that while their example was simple, real-world applications might involve extensive concept briefs. Clément also mentioned the potential to create a front-end web portal for clients to submit requests, which could be explored later.
- **Setting Up the Trigger in Zapier with Google Sheets** Clément guided participants through setting up the trigger in Zapier, specifically choosing Google Sheets as the trigger application. They instructed to select "New Spreadsheet Row" as the trigger event and connect their Google account, then choose the appropriate spreadsheet, worksheet (tab), and trigger column. Clément demonstrated how to test the trigger to ensure it pulls the correct data from the Google Sheet.
- **Troubleshooting Trigger Setup** Sara Hofmann encountered an issue where no options were available for the trigger column, which Clément diagnosed as a problem with the spreadsheet's column setup. Vladimir also asked about "content hash" during the test trigger, which Clément clarified as irrelevant metadata. Clément confirmed that the trigger should now be set up for everyone.
- **Setting Up the Action Step with ChatGPT** Clément proceeded to the next action step: script generation with ChatGPT. They instructed to add an action step, select "Chat GPT" by OpenAI, and choose the "Conversation" action event.

Clément explained to ignore other options like "Assistant Conversation" or "Conversation Legacy" and select the primary "Conversation" option.

- **OpenAI Models and Usage** Clément Lacaille explained that OpenAI models, such as GPT-3 and GPT-4, are designed for different tasks, with GPT-3 excelling in long reasoning statements and GPT-4 (or GPT-4o mini) being faster and more cost-effective for automation workflows. He emphasized that the system automatically chooses the model based on the input, rather than the user manually selecting it. Clément Lacaille also clarified that user messages provide input to ChatGPT, which must be in JSON language, and system messages offer instructions.
- **API Key Issues and Solutions** Kai Feldhoff reported that their API key had expired, but Vladimir Popovic confirmed their key was working. Clément Lacaille suggested re-entering the key and pasting the associated organization ID, and also clarified that using one's own OpenAI API key requires setting up a paid account on the OpenAI platform. Hashmatullah Armani inquired about account association with the API key, and Naim Burrack clarified that the account is tied to the provided API key.
- **Crafting Prompts for ChatGPT** Clément Lacaille guided participants on how to write prompts for ChatGPT, focusing on user and system messages within an automation workflow. He explained that the process involves providing context, defining a task, and specifying the desired output format, including examples and constraints. Clément Lacaille also demonstrated how to use ChatGPT to generate the system and user prompts, refining them for conciseness and proper JSON formatting.
- **JSON Language and Data Mapping** Clément Lacaille detailed the use of JSON language for inputs and outputs in Zapier, describing it as a key-value structure that enables communication with ChatGPT. He demonstrated how to map data from an Excel sheet to the JSON fields in the user message, allowing ChatGPT to recognize and process variables like video request, target audience, and product image.
- **Troubleshooting Data Refresh in Zapier** Vladimir Popovic encountered an issue where changes made to row names in a Google Sheet were not reflected in Zapier, as the system retained the old name. Clément Lacaille explained that to update the row names in Zapier, users need to go back to the trigger step, select

"Find New Records," and choose the updated row. This process ensures that Zapier pulls the latest data structure from the connected Google Sheet.

- **Refining System Messages for Clarity** Clément Lacaille addressed the need for concise and clear system messages, noting that large JSON schemas can be problematic and that, for simpler automations, text-only values are preferred over JSON for the system message. He demonstrated how to instruct ChatGPT to provide the system message in a clean, single-box format without breaks, ensuring better readability and implementation in Zapier.
- **Improving Script Output and Homework** Clément Lacaille provided feedback on the generated script, suggesting that while it was decent, further improvements could be made by modifying the system prompt to include more specific details like actor information and visual cues. He emphasized the importance of providing more context in the Excel sheet, such as brand identity, target audience, and past messaging successes, to train the LLM for better script generation. The homework assigned was to experiment with prompts to improve the output quality.
- **JSON Parsing in Zapier** Sven Lück shared their experience with Zapier's formatter, noting that it lacked a direct option for parsing JSON and that they had to use custom JavaScript code as a workaround. Clément Lacaille acknowledged this limitation, explaining that Zapier is not ideally designed for complex workflows involving JSON parsing, unlike other platforms.
- **Accessing Meeting Recordings** Razieh Dorrazaei, who missed previous sessions, inquired about accessing meeting recordings. Clément Lacaille provided a direct link to the drive containing the recordings and also advised joining the Slack group, where all lesson recordings, including the current one, are available.
- **Automating Content Creation** Clément Lacaille guided Vladimir Popovic through creating an automation workflow on Zapier to generate UGC video content. They discussed setting up the workflow by inputting data from Google Sheets, defining the task to create system instructions for Zapier OpenAI conversation nodes, and specifying output examples and elements desired in the video scripts. The instructions should turn brief inputs from Google Sheets into high-performing UGC ads, potentially by providing a script example with principles like a hook, detailed actor descriptions, and scene format.
- **Custom GPTs and Character Design** Clément Lacaille demonstrated a custom GPT they created for character design, trained on Disney, Pixar, and Ghibli

methodologies. This custom GPT helps users extract details, identify gaps, refer to a knowledge base, and create backstories, shape language, and infer context for characters. The output is an image prompt design for characters, usable in tools like Midjourney or Nanobana, along with variations and specific format requirements.

- **Customization vs. Generic Output** Clément Lacaille explained that the level of customization for instructions depends on the use case, distinguishing between generic UGC videos and specialized content for specific brands like jewelry. They emphasized that customized instructions yield customized outputs, which is preferred by brands over generic outputs, and that providing examples and data to learn from helps prevent the AI from "hallucinating". Clément Lacaille also briefly mentioned vector databases as a way to allow the agent to learn from various use cases without needing to customize for every single brand.

Suggested next steps

- [ ] The group will try with Google forms.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will paste the instructions on sheets later.
- [ ] The group will go back and try to improve the output of their prompt.